

# Building Confidence

— From Self-Doubt to First Move

*Your Confidence Compass is on the table — you'll use it four times today.*

TODAY

From what's held you back — to one real thing you do differently by the end.

|                |                 |                      |                   |                |                  |              |
|----------------|-----------------|----------------------|-------------------|----------------|------------------|--------------|
| 1              | 2               | 3                    | 4                 | 5              | 6                | 7            |
| Name the doubt | Find your value | Sharpen your message | Manage the moment | Make your move | Hold your ground | Move forward |

FRAMING · ONE OF TWO

Confidence isn't loud, visible or dominant.

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Quiet and considered responses count too.

FRAMING · TWO OF TWO

# Acting while still uncertain — not the absence of doubt.



That's what entrepreneurial confidence means here.

## HOW TODAY WORKS

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- Individual first. You think on your own before anything is shared.
- Pairing is always opt-out-able.
- Nothing leaves the room unless you volunteer it.

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## YOUR PARTNER FOR THE DAY

You'll have one partner for the paired moments across the workshop. If at any point that isn't working for you, let me know privately — you don't need to tell me why, and I'll sort out a change.

# 1

REFLECTION

0:15 – 0:45

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## Name the Doubt

| Nothing in this next half hour needs to be said aloud.

# Imposter syndrome

Difficulty internalizing your own success: attributing your achievements to factors other than your own ability, and fearing you'll be exposed as less capable than others believe.

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## MYTH / REALITY

Doubt isn't evidence of unreadiness.

Clance & Imes, 1978 — “imposter phenomenon”

EMMA

*Emma is accepted to present at a conference —  
and doubts she's earned it.*



## Take a few quiet minutes

You don't need to write anything unless it helps you — just notice whether anything like Emma's experience has happened to you.

6:00

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CLICK TO START

This is just for you. No one sees it unless you choose to share it.

# One word, if you want to

Turn to your partner and share one word for how that noticing felt. One word only.

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## SHARE ONE WORD

Say it to your partner, and hear theirs.

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## OR PASS

Tell your partner you'd rather not, or sit quietly together. Completely fine.

# 2

VALUE

0:45 – 1:15

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## Find Your Value

| Naming a skill or ability clearly, with evidence, so others understand the value.

MYTH

Only directly relevant skills count.

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REALITY

A strength becomes valuable once you connect it clearly to the outcome.

Emma hesitates to mention her design background in a mentorship circle — until she connects it to what the group is trying to do.

Write down one strength you have — and one specific moment it showed up.

At work, in study, or in life.

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Stuck? Try one of these:

What do people regularly ask for your help with?

What's one thing you do particularly well?

What specific example shows it?

Tell your partner about it in your own words — you don't need to read what you wrote word for word.

Partner: reflect it back.

| “*What I hear as your strength is \_\_\_\_, and I saw it in \_\_\_\_.*”

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OR KEEP IT  
PRIVATE

Keep your strength to yourself and simply confirm with your partner that you're ready to move on.

Think of a strength you have that doesn't seem directly related to your venture or goal. How might it actually be an asset once you explain the connection?

# 3

CLARITY

1:15 – 1:35

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## Sharpen Your Message

Your key message is the one thing you want remembered,  
even if everything else is forgotten.



MYTH

Covering many points means they'll remember what matters most.

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REALITY

One clear message does.

After Emma's rehearsal, a friend recalls three different things — none of them her intended point.

# Write the one sentence you most want remembered.

From what you just told your partner — the one thing that matters most.

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## THEN TEST IT

Read it to your partner. A moment later, without looking at anything, they'll say it back in their own words.

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## OR SHOW IT IN WRITING

Chat, screen or paper instead of reading it aloud.

If someone asked a listener afterward “what was the one thing they said,” would the answer match what you intended?

1:35 — 1:45

# Break

Ten minutes. We'll start again promptly  
— bring your sharpened sentence back  
with you.

# 10:00

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CLICK TO START

# 4

NERVES

1:45 – 2:00

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## Manage the Moment

You're about to use that sentence. First, the feeling that comes just before.

Trying on a different word for the same sensation can change how it's experienced.

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Research on anxiety reappraisal suggests that interpreting pre-performance arousal as excitement can support performance.

EMMA

*Heart racing backstage, a mentor suggests she say “I’m excited” instead.*

Notice the physical feeling you get before doing something that takes nerve — and the word you usually use for it.

Now try swapping that word for *excited*.

Say your usual word once to your partner, then say “excited” instead. Notice what shifts — or doesn’t.

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SILENTLY OR IN  
WRITING

You can do the noticing and the swap on your own instead of saying it to a partner.



# 5

ACTION

2:00 – 2:35

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## Make Your Move

| That feeling is exactly what you're bringing into this.

## Speculative outreach

Reaching out with no advertised opening — connecting your value to something specific about the recipient, with a low-pressure ask.

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### MYTH / REALITY

A speculative message doesn't need to justify itself at length. Short, specific and low-pressure works best.

Emma nearly deletes an over-long message to a design studio.

Think of one real person or organization you could reach out to.

Write two lines:

- 1 One reason you're reaching out, specific to them.
- 2 One small, easy-to-say-yes-to ask.

6:00

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CLICK TO START

Page 3 of your Compass has space for both.

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Test it with your partner — read it aloud.

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THEIR ONLY JOB

Answer honestly: is the ask clear, specific, and easy to respond to?

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OR DRAFT IN PRIVATE

Skip the read-aloud and go straight to your own decision about what happens next.

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Two options — and neither is better than the other.

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Send it now

If you're ready, send your message in this room, today.

Or commit to seven days

Write down one specific action and a date within the next seven days.

No one needs to say which one they're doing, or who the message is for.

# Your move

Send it, or write your action and its date.  
Take the whole window either way.

Nobody is asked which path they took.

# 8:00

CLICK TO START

# 6

RESILIENCE

2:35 – 2:50

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## Hold Your Ground

Not every outreach lands well. This is about holding whatever comes back.

Taking in what a rejection actually tells you — without treating it as a verdict on your worth, and without dismissing it as meaningless.

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*“A rejection is information about an outcome, not a complete verdict on your capability or worth. You can examine what it tells you without letting it define you.”*

Emma's instinct, reading a rejection email from an accelerator, is to assume it confirms every doubt.



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Think of a rejection you've experienced. Write down one thing that was still true about your skill or effort, regardless of that outcome.

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THEN, WITH YOUR PARTNER

*“So even after that, \_\_\_ was still true.”*

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OR REFLECT PRIVATELY

Your partner simply confirms you're ready to move on.

- 1 Doubt named
- 2 Value found
- 3 Message sharpened
- 4 Moment managed
- 5 Action taken
- 6 Setback held

Success isn't only feeling more confident today. It's what that confidence helps you do next.

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# Thank you

Take your Confidence Compass with you — the seven-day page is yours alone.

BUILDING CONFIDENCE

FROM SELF-DOUBT TO FIRST MOVE

## REFERENCES

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Brooks, A. W. (2014). Get excited: Reappraising pre-performance anxiety as excitement. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, 143(3), 1144–1158. <https://doi.org/10.1037/a0035325>

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Clance, P. R., & Imes, S. A. (1978). The imposter phenomenon in high achieving women: Dynamics and therapeutic intervention. *Psychotherapy: Theory, Research & Practice*, 15(3), 241–247.